

that nobody would have believed was possible in 2014.

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India Stack was prominently displayed at various G20 meetings. Will the government offer it for free?

We are now calling it the India Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI) because DPI is a phrase now. During the Indian presidency of the G20, the phrase DPI was defined. The framework has been set, principles put together. There is consensus now—[on] the framework, the architecture and the principles on what is DPI, what is the functionality of DPI. So what India has done in the last five years, from Aadhaar to UPI to eSanjeevani to DigiLocker to Bhashini, we are offering as a stack or individually to any country

sign with another 30—the interest is that deep. But we are also not sitting with a ready-made amount of talent or talent pool or developer ecosystem that can support all of this at the same time.

So we are, in a sense, working with these eight countries initially, and building the developer ecosystem in India, building the skilling capabilities in India or helping not just implement this stack or transfer the technology of India DPI, but at the same time helping their ecosystem to build their own start-up and customisation capabilities. So, it is free of cost as far as the government is concerned. It is open source, and there can be very many different variants of it.

Trinidad and Tobago could have a variant of the UPI, Sierra Leone could have a variant of the Aadhaar

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that wants it. Prime Minister [Narendra Modi] has said that we certainly want to enable the countries of the Global South, who have in a sense been left out of the digital train for several years, [because] what they believed was an expensive or a big tech process.

We now offer it [DPI] to them and [have] created in parallel with the G20, the concept of a global DPI repository, which will all be open source, which will all be available to any country that wants to take that, customise that and develop their own digital model of governance and innovation. About eight countries have [already] signed MoUs. We can

and the global DPI repository will have all these various DPIs.

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What new services are you looking at integrating into the DPI?

That's a good question. The Prime Minister's vision is that there will be no part of government that will be left without any digital asset. So, effectively, you will see that DPI now spans the entire spectrum of public services. There will be at least 20 to 30 new applications that will pile up on the India DPI that will address different slivers of the public service stack.

@nidhisingal

now and have reached a level of maturity and robustness. Multiple use cases have been built and implemented in India, which means countries adopting it don't have to start from scratch and can use these solutions to scale up fast," says Devroop Dhar, Co-founder of consultancy firm Primus Partners.

This success is evident from the eight MoUs signed with other countries that was mentioned above. Armenia, Sierra Leone, Suriname, Antigua, Barbados, Trinidad and Tobago, Papua New Guinea, and Mauritius have all signed pacts that allow them to access the India DPI at no cost and with open-source access. These nations can now use these resources to develop their unique innovations.

Among the bouquet of services, there are clear favourites. Apeksha Kaushik, Principal Analyst at Gartner, says, "The countries signing up with India are mostly interested in UPI and DigiLocker (the cloud-based platform for document and certificate storage, sharing and verification)." She adds that the government is offering many other platforms in the agreements, including Modular Open Source Identity Platform (MOSIP), Covid-19 vaccination platform Co-WIN and the National Health Stack. Some countries are also said to have expressed interest in the Digital Infrastructure for Knowledge Sharing (DIKSHA) and National Digital Education Architecture (NDEAR).

Rajeev Chandrasekhar, Union Minister of State in the Ministry of Electronics & IT (MeitY), says the interest in India's DPI is so deep that the country can sign deals with 30 more countries.

But the popularity of India's DPI has run up against a challenge that